

TEACHER KEY · NOT FOR STUDENTS

Financial Literacy

Sample answers · Weeks 31–36

Mr. Fung · EIPS · 2026–2027

1. Week 31 — Need or want?
2. Week 32 — Two goals, one saving plan
3. Week 33 — A simple budget
4. Week 34 — What is pulling on this choice?
5. Week 35 — Four jobs for money (and time)
6. Week 36 — My Grade 5 financial plan

Week 31: Needs and Wants

Need or want?

Item / Need, want, or depends? / Why

Lunch for school: Lunch: need. Cards: want. Helmet: need (safety). Brand hoodie: depends (clothing vs logo). Charger: depends (reach a parent vs extra). Movie snacks: want.

One need in my life

Winter boots that still fit.

One want I can wait for

A new pencil case with a character on it.

Exit ticket — Why does mixing up needs and wants make planning harder?

The want can empty the jar before the boots are covered. You can still enjoy a want after needs are covered, or with a plan.

Look-fors

- Can they explain a “depends” item?
- No shaming of what others have?

Tip. Some students have almost no spending money. Use school examples (choosing a free activity vs a paid one) so everyone can play.

Week 32: Saving and Financial Goals

Two goals, one saving plan

/ Short-term goal / Long-term goal

What I would save for: Short: used chapter-book set, \$16, 4 weeks, \$4/week. Long: used helmet and lights, \$60, 12 weeks, \$5/week.

One want I would pause to hit the short-term goal

Extra vending popcorn this weekend.

Exit ticket — How can a short-term save (habit) help a long-term goal?

The habit — putting money aside on purpose — is the same skill. A smaller number first makes the bigger goal more possible.

Look-fors

- Both goals have a time and a rough amount?
- Division attempted (even if you help)?

Tip. If math stalls the 12 minutes, give the weekly amount and have them check it. The Health idea is the plan, not long division.

Week 33: Simple Budgets

A simple budget

Sample: You have \$30 for a month of “fun + save.” Goal: \$12 saved for a class t-shirt. Needs (bus/snack fund) \$10. How much is left for wants?

Budget part / Amount (\$) / Need, want, save, or donate?

Money I have or will get: In \$30. Need \$10 (bus/snack). Want \$8. Save \$12 (t-shirt). Donate \$0. $30 = 10 + 8 + 12$.

Does it balance (in = out + save)?

Yes

Exit ticket — What is a budget, in one sentence?

A budget is a plan for money coming in and going out — including saving on purpose, not as a leftover.

Look-fors

- Needs before wants?
- Saving is a line, not an accident?

Tip. Always offer sample dollars. Never require a real family income.

Week 34: Consumer Choices — What Influences Us

What is pulling on this choice?

One item (sample is fine — do not name what a classmate owns)

Limited-edition cards, \$8, “last chance” ad.

Influences I notice (check all that apply)

- ☐ Advertising / “limited time”
- ☐ Friends or belonging
- ☐ Price (it seems cheap or it seems expensive)
- ☐ Quality / how long it lasts
- ☐ Packaging or being at checkout
- ☐ Feeling (bored, stressed, left out)

Is this a need, a want, or a want dressed up as a need? Why?

A want dressed up as a need by belonging and a countdown. I do not need them to be well.

My plan

Wait one week

Exit ticket — Why does noticing an influence help a financial goal?

If I buy on autopilot, the want can empty the jar before the goal. Noticing lets me choose on purpose.

Look-fors

- More than one influence named?
- Decision connected to a plan, not to shame?

Tip. Do not roast anyone’s shoes or lunch. Use sample products.

Week 35: Planning: Earn, Spend, Save, Donate

Four jobs for money (and time)

Job / What this looks like this month (sample dollars are fine)

Earn: Earn: sample \$5 family task. Spend need: \$2 bus. Spend want: \$0 this week. Save: \$3 helmet.
Donate: 20 minutes lost-and-found (time).

How does this plan support one financial goal I named in Week 32 or 33?

The \$3 a week is the habit toward the \$60 helmet. The want is paused. Time-donate keeps contribution in the plan even at \$0.

Exit ticket — Why can donating time count in a financial-literacy plan in Grade 5?

Not every student has money to give. Time, talent, and energy are contribution (Week 1) and they belong in a well-being plan.

Look-fors

- Save is a line?
- Donate allowed to be time?
- No required family income?

Tip. If a student is proud of a large donate number from a family, accept it without turning it into a class contest.

Week 36: My Financial Plan

My Grade 5 financial plan

One need I will cover first

Bus / snack fund.

One want I can wait for (or plan for)

Limited-edition cards — wait one week.

One goal: what, about how much, how many weeks, weekly save

Class t-shirt, \$12, 4 weeks, \$3 a week.

A tiny budget that balances (in = needs + wants + save + donate)

In \$20. Need \$8. Want \$0 this month. Save \$12. Donate \$0 + recycling time. Balances.

One influence I will notice before I buy

"Last chance" ads and belonging at the table.

Exit ticket — How does planning support a financial goal — in one sentence?

A goal with a number and a time, needs covered first, and wants chosen on purpose — so the jar is not empty by accident.

Look-fors

- Goal has a number and a time?
- Budget attempted?
- No family-income sharing?

Tip. Celebrate the plan, not the dollar size. A \$4 field-trip fee is as valid as a \$60 helmet.